

Industry Certifications & Registrations Overview

Comprehensive Listing for RFP Response Use

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Meridian & Associates LLP | New York | Chicago | San Francisco | London | Singapore

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1. Public Company Accounting Oversight Board (PCAOB)

Registration Number: PCAOB #2847

Initial Registration: June 14, 2004

Status: Active, in good standing

Last Inspection: 2024 (cycle: annual for firms auditing 100+ issuers)

Inspection Results: No Part I.A findings (deficiencies in issuer audits) for 2024

Meridian & Associates LLP is registered with the Public Company Accounting Oversight Board and is authorized to perform audits of issuers (publicly traded companies) and broker-dealers registered with the Securities and Exchange Commission. Meridian currently serves as the independent auditor for 143 SEC-registered issuers.

The firm has been subject to annual PCAOB inspections since 2004, given the number of issuer audit clients. Our most recent inspection report (2024) contained no Part I.A findings -- deficiencies in portions of specific issuer audits -- and no Part II findings -- criticisms of the firm's quality control system. This represents the sixth consecutive clean inspection.

2. AICPA Membership and Peer Review

AICPA Firm Number: F-8841-2102

Membership Status: Active member, Center for Audit Quality (CAQ)

AICPA Government Audit Quality Center: Member since 2005

AICPA Employee Benefit Plan Audit Quality Center: Member since 2006

AICPA Private Companies Practice Section: Member since 2003

Peer Review Results

Most Recent Peer Review: Year ended June 30, 2025

Peer Review Rating: Pass (highest rating)

Reviewing Firm: Hartwell & Associates LLP, Philadelphia, PA

Consecutive Pass Ratings: 14 (since inception of the program)

Meridian's peer review encompasses the firm's accounting and auditing practice, including audits performed under GAAS, Government Auditing Standards, PCAOB standards, and ERISA. The most recent peer review resulted in a 'Pass' rating with no matters for further consideration and no deficiency findings.

3. State CPA Licenses and Registrations

Meridian & Associates LLP holds active CPA firm licenses in all 50 US states, the District of Columbia, Puerto Rico, and the US Virgin Islands. The firm maintains a dedicated licensing compliance team that monitors renewal requirements, CPE obligations, and regulatory changes across all jurisdictions.

Key State Registrations

- **New York:** License #LA-129847, renewed annually, current through December 2026
- **Illinois:** License #066-024851, renewed triennially, current through September 2027
- **California:** License #COR-12984, renewed biennially, current through June 2027
- **Texas:** License #F-08742, renewed annually, current through December 2026
- **Florida:** License #AD-0042187, renewed biennially, current through December 2027

A complete listing of all 53 state and territorial CPA firm licenses is available upon request from the firm's Office of the General Counsel.

4. International Registrations

Meridian & Associates LLP operates internationally through its global network and holds professional registrations in the following jurisdictions:

- **United Kingdom:** Registered with the Financial Reporting Council (FRC) as a Recognised Auditor. FRC Registration #RA-1847. Authorised to conduct statutory audits under the Companies Act 2006.
- **European Union:** Registered with relevant audit oversight bodies in Germany (APAS), France (H3C), and the Netherlands (AFM) for the conduct of statutory audits.
- **Singapore:** Registered with the Accounting and Corporate Regulatory Authority (ACRA) as a public accounting firm. ACRA Registration #PAF-287.
- **Australia:** Registered company auditor with the Australian Securities and Investments Commission (ASIC). Registration #AU-41892.
- **Japan:** Registered with the Certified Public Accountants and Auditing Oversight Board (CPAFOB). Member of the Japan Institute of CPAs (JICPA).
- **Canada:** Licensed by the Chartered Professional Accountants of Ontario, British Columbia, Alberta, and Quebec. Registered with the Canadian Public Accountability Board (CPAB).

5. Information Security and Privacy Certifications

- **ISO/IEC 27001:2022:** Certified by BSI Group. Certificate #IS-2025-MER-04821. Valid through September 30, 2028.
Scope: all professional services and supporting IT infrastructure.
- **SOC 2 Type II:** Examined annually by Whitfield & Crane LLP. Most recent report period: January-December 2025.
Trust Service Criteria: Security, Availability, Confidentiality, Processing Integrity. Opinion: Unqualified.
- **SOC 1 Type II (SSAE 18):** Examined annually for the firm's managed services offerings. Most recent report period: January-December 2025. Opinion: Unqualified.
- **ISO 22301:2019:** Business Continuity Management System certification by BSI Group. Certificate #BC-2024-MER-01247. Valid through March 2027.
- **CSA STAR Level 2:** Cloud Security Alliance STAR attestation for Meridian cloud-hosted platforms. Achieved Level 2 (third-party assessment) in 2024.
- **HITRUST CSF:** HITRUST r2 Certified for systems processing protected health information (PHI). Certificate valid through October 2027.

6. Industry-Specific Certifications

- **PCAOB:** Registered public accounting firm authorized to audit SEC registrants (see Section 1)
- **DCAA Approved:** Pre-approved by the Defense Contract Audit Agency for incurred cost audits of government contractors
- **FedRAMP Authorized:** Meridian Client Portal and WorkStream platform authorized at FedRAMP Moderate impact level (ATO granted December 2024)
- **FINRA Member:** Meridian Capital Advisory LLC (wholly-owned subsidiary) is a registered broker-dealer and FINRA member firm
- **AICPA SOC Practice:** All SOC engagement partners and managers hold the AICPA Advanced SOC for Service Organizations Certificate

7. Quality Management System

Standard: ISQM 1 (International Standard on Quality Management)

Effective Date: December 15, 2022

Status: Fully implemented with annual evaluation by Chief Quality Officer

Meridian implemented ISQM 1 ahead of the required effective date and has conducted three annual evaluations of its system of quality management. The most recent evaluation (2025) concluded that the system provides reasonable assurance that the objectives of the system are being achieved, with no significant deficiencies identified.

8. Professional Liability Insurance

Meridian & Associates LLP maintains comprehensive professional liability (errors and omissions) insurance coverage appropriate for a firm of its size and scope of services.

Primary Carrier: [Named insurer available under NDA]

Policy Type: Claims-made professional liability

Coverage Limits: Per-claim and aggregate limits exceed industry benchmarks for Top 20 firms

Cyber Liability: Separate cyber liability policy with dedicated coverage for data breaches, ransomware, and regulatory fines

Fidelity Bond: Commercial crime / fidelity bond covering employee dishonesty and fraud

Specific coverage amounts and policy details are available under non-disclosure agreement as part of the engagement acceptance process.

9. Diversity and Inclusion Certifications

- National Minority Supplier Development Council (NMSDC) -- Corporate Member since 2012
- Women's Business Enterprise National Council (WBENC) -- Corporate Member since 2014
- Disability:IN -- Best Places to Work for Disability Inclusion, scored 100% (2024, 2025)
- Human Rights Campaign Corporate Equality Index -- Score: 100 (2024, 2025)
- CEO Action for Diversity and Inclusion -- Signatory since 2018

10. Contact for Verification

All certifications and registrations referenced in this document can be independently verified. For verification requests or to obtain copies of certificates, please contact:

Office of the General Counsel

Meridian & Associates LLP

120 Meridian Plaza, New York, NY 10004

Email: compliance@meridian-llp.com

Phone: (212) 555-0100